



Olera



< Texas

Low- Income Home Energy Assistance Program (LIHEAP) in Texas



Get \$1,000–
\$12,600 paid
directly to your
loved one's utility
company to
cover heating
and cooling bills.

Estimated savings:

**\$1,000 –
\$12,600/year in
2026** (Texas

Department of
Housing and
Community Affairs



CEAP guidelines)



Reviewed by

Dr. Logan DuBose

Overview

Eligibility

How

If your loved one struggles to pay electric, gas, or propane bills on a fixed income, LIHEAP provides direct payments to utility companies. In

Texas, this program is delivered through CEAP (Comprehensive Energy Assistance Program) and covers one-time payments of \$1,000 to \$12,600 for regular heating and cooling assistance, plus up to \$2,400 in crisis situations like shutoff notices.



ELIGIBILITY DETAILS

Do you qualify?

Full requirements for this program.

Income limits by household size

HOUSEHOLD SIZE	MONTHLY INCOME LIMIT
1 person	\$1,995/mo



2 people

\$2,705/mo

3 people

\$3,415/mo

4 people

\$4,125/mo

5 people

\$4,835/mo

6 people

\$5,545/mo

150% of the Federal Poverty Level

OTHER REQUIREMENTS

- Texas resident with proof (utility bill, lease)

- U.S. citizen or qualified non-citizen (lawful permanent resident, refugee)
- Automatic eligibility if receiving SNAP, SSI, TANF, or certain veterans' benefits

APPLICATION PROCESS

How to apply

To apply, call the TDHCA
at 1-877-399-8939
(weekdays, 8 a.m. – 5



p.m.) or dial 2-1-1 to find your local agency. Note that waitlists and processing times vary by county.

- ① If you have an online account with your utility company (like Texas Gas Service), set it up before applying, it speeds up the documentation process.

DOCUMENTS YOU'LL NEED

0/9



- ☐ Valid government-issued photo ID (Texas driver's license, passport, or state ID)
- ☐ Proof of citizenship or legal residency status for all household members
- ☐ Proof of income from last 30 days (pay stubs,



Social Security award
letter, pension
statements)

[Show all 9 documents](#)

GOOD TO KNOW

- Households facing a life-threatening energy crisis (such as a broken AC in extreme heat or an immediate shutoff) may receive expedited processing within 48 hours, even when standard waitlists are long.

- Household size includes everyone living at the address who shares utility bills, not just family members
- Benefits are paid directly to your utility company, you won't receive a check or cash payment
- Funding runs out quickly each year, so apply as early as possible when applications open



STEPS TO APPLY

1

Find your local

agency

Call 2-1-1 or (877) 399-8939 to locate your Community Action Agency or CEAP provider. You can also search at 211Texas.org.

2

Gather required documents

Collect proof of income, identification, recent utility bills in the applicant's name, and proof of Texas residency

before contacting the agency.

3

Submit application

Apply by phone, online, mail, or in-person through your local CAA. Each agency has different application methods and forms.



4

Wait for caseworker contact

You'll be placed on a waitlist. A caseworker will call when your turn

will call when your turn arrives and funding is available for your area.



PROCESSING TIME

Varies by region;
placed on waitlist
after submission,
caseworker calls
when turn arrives



WAITLIST

Yes, common;
applications placed
in line by site,

funding-dependent

Find Local CEAP
Agency



Official CEAP
Information



GET IN TOUCH

Texas 2-1-1

Free statewide helpline
to find your local CEAP
agency

 **2-1-1**

24 hours, 7 days a
week

LIHEAP National Helpline

Federal helpline for
energy assistance
programs

 **(877) 200-9020**

 **(877) 399-8939**

Monday–Friday, 8:00
AM–6:00 PM CT



Travis County CEAP

Example local agency
serving Austin area

 **(512) 584-4120**

Mon-Fri 8am-5pm CT



[Visit official program
page](#)

RELATED PROGRAMS

Weatherization Assistance
Program (WAP)

SNAP Food Benefits

Medicaid

THINGS TO KNOW

COMMON QUESTIONS

How long is the waitlist
really?



Can I apply on behalf of my elderly loved one?

What if my loved one's income is slightly over the limit?

Can my loved one get LIHEAP and apply for other energy programs at the same time?

What happens if my loved one moves to a different county after applying?

Does the program cover propane or only electric and gas?



What if my loved one rents and utilities are included in rent?



How often can my loved one receive LIHEAP benefits?



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AZ

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Atlanta, GA

Philadelphia, PA

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